

Deliver Software Faster with Secure DevSecOps

In the new digital world, businesses are demanding quick release cycles. Teams have started adopting continuous integration and continuous delivery practices along with other agile practices. Let's see how this is done.

Quality software has been delivered and agile methodologies have been practised for quite a while now, and have helped to build applications faster. At first glance, this probably looks like the perfect setup for delivering certain software. Figure 1 depicts this scenario.

An important question is: should we deliver quality software or secured quality software? Why is security important? Just take a look at the data breaches and hacks. Their number increases every year and the number of records stolen is also huge.

Application security has never been more important and it's going to get even more focused. So how do we add security in the whole process? Can we do a source code review or carry out penetration testing with an expert? No, these processes will slow us down. This need for automation is what has given birth to DevSecOps.

DevSecOps

Traditionally, security was always an afterthought, done very late in the life cycle with a small set of people involved for a short period. DevSecOps adds a new perspective to security.

- It brings automation to security
- Offers faster feedback — developers get feedback as they write the code
- It uses tools to overcome limited human knowledge
- Gives continuous feedback, and not a one-time review before release

In short, DevSecOps enables software delivery at speed. It is also the new approach to operationalise security. For continuous secure delivery, we need to bring security practices in the earlier stages of software development (shift left approach). To achieve this, we need to focus on the five key things listed in Figure 5.

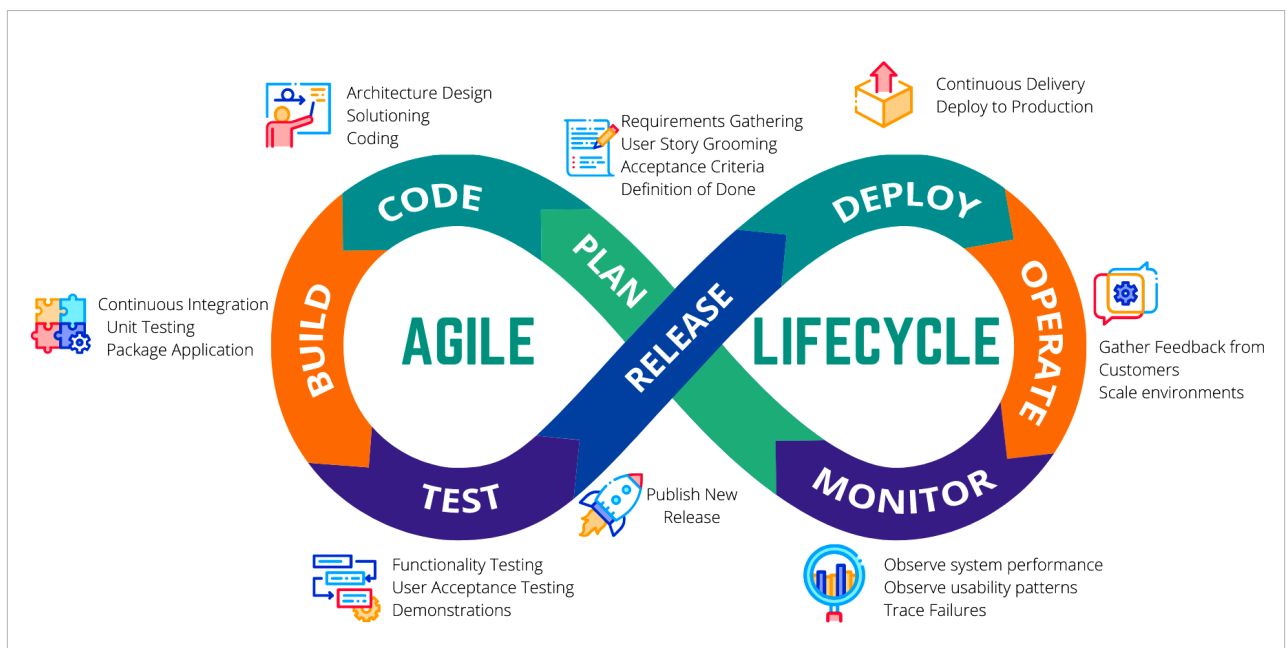


Figure 1: Agile life cycle